

# Digital Burnout & Mental Fitness

## How to Stay Human in a Tech-Driven World

A Special Webinar for IT Students

Date: [Insert Date] | Presented by: [Your Name]

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# Why We’re Here

### Always Online, High Expectations

As IT students, you're constantly connected, juggling demanding coursework and striving for excellence in a fast-paced environment.

### The Comparison Trap

Comparing GitHub profiles, grades, and projects with peers can lead to feelings of inadequacy and impostor syndrome.

### You Are Not Alone

If you're feeling exhausted, anxious, or emotionally drained, remember that these experiences are common and understandable.

Your brain is like a CPU — too many tabs open and it starts to overheat. It's time to manage the load.

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# What is Digital Burnout?

Digital burnout is the emotional and mental exhaustion that arises from being **constantly connected** to digital devices and platforms.



## Constant Coding

Endless hours focused on complex problems without sufficient breaks.



## Endless Notifications

The continuous ping of messages, updates, and alerts demanding your attention.



## Social Comparison

The pressure to keep up with perceived successes of others online.



## Zero Downtime

A lack of clear boundaries between work, study, and personal life, leading to a perpetually active mind.

Who has pulled an all-nighter just to ‘catch up’? 🙋‍♂️🙋‍♀️ You're not alone, but let's find better ways.

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# Signs You’re Burning Out

Recognising the symptoms of digital burnout is the first step towards recovery. Pay attention to these common indicators:

- Brain fog / lack of focus
- Headaches, eye strain
- Poor sleep or irregular cycles
- Frustration while coding
- Feeling isolated
- Increased anxiety or irritability
- Loss of motivation
- Impostor syndrome

You’re like a laptop running 100 programs at once — everything lags, even your mood. It's time to close some programs.

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# Why IT Students Are More at Risk

The unique pressures of IT studies amplify the risk of digital burnout:

1

## Intense Academic Demands

Constant deadlines, challenging exams, and complex projects require sustained mental effort.

2

## Excessive Screen Time

The nature of IT means heavy daily screen exposure, often extending into personal time.

3

## Perfectionism & Comparison

A drive for perfection, coupled with comparing achievements to talented peers, creates immense pressure.

4

## Screen-Based "Breaks"

Even leisure activities like gaming or social media often involve more screen time, preventing true mental breaks.

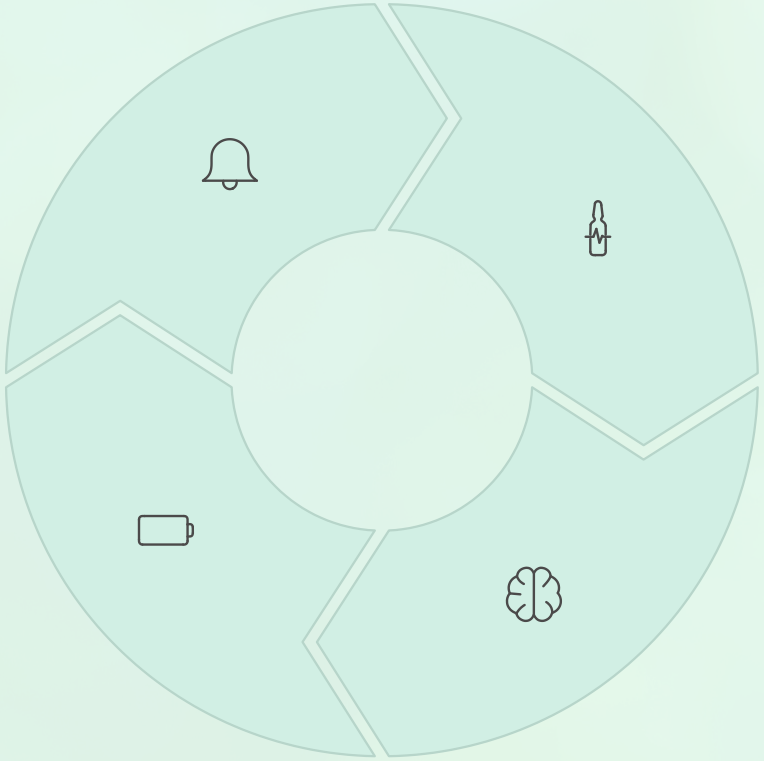
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# How Tech Affects Your Brain

Our brains are wired for reward, and technology exploits this with immediate feedback loops, which can become a detrimental cycle.

### Dopamine Hits

Notifications and social media interactions trigger instant reward, creating a craving for more.



### Stress Hormones

Deadlines and high stakes projects elevate cortisol, leading to tension and ultimately burnout.

### Exhausted, Yet Craving

The brain becomes exhausted but seeks more stimulation to feel "normal," perpetuating the cycle.

### Overstimulated Brain

This combination leads to a brain constantly in "on" mode, preventing true rest.

Your brain is like a phone battery — constantly charging and draining, never quite reaching 100%. Let's aim for a full charge.

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# Focus & Attention

In a tech-saturated world, maintaining focus is a superpower. Understand how technology impacts your attention span:

- **The Multitasking Myth:** Juggling multiple tasks simultaneously doesn't increase productivity; it actually reduces it.
- **Task-Switching Drain:** Constantly shifting between tasks depletes cognitive resources, leaving you mentally fatigued and less effective.
- **Low Focus Stamina:** A heavy tech load can diminish your ability to sustain attention on a single task, leading to decreased concentration.

## Mini Activity:

Close everything for 1 minute. Focus on one word on the screen and notice how easily your mind gets distracted.

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# Relaxation Exercise: 60-second Guided Breathing

Take a moment to reset your mind and body with this simple breathing exercise. Your mind is like RAM — clearing it now helps your brain run smoother.

01

## Find Your Comfort

Sit comfortably with your back straight, feet flat on the floor, or lie down if preferred.

02

## Gentle Inhale

Inhale slowly and deeply through your nose for 4 seconds, feeling your belly rise.

03

## Pause and Hold

Hold your breath gently for 4 seconds, allowing the oxygen to settle.

04

## Exhale Fully

Exhale slowly through your mouth for 4 seconds, releasing all the air and tension.

05

## Another Pause

Hold your breath out for 4 seconds before the next inhale.

06

## Visualise Calm

Close your eyes and imagine a calm, still lake. Repeat the cycle 3 times.

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# Digital Hygiene: Practical Tools for a Healthier You

Implement these strategies to create a more balanced relationship with your technology:

- **Set Clear Boundaries**

  Turn off notifications while you're focused on coding or studying. Designate specific "no-tech" times.

- **Prioritise Screen Breaks**

  Take 5-10 minute breaks every hour. Stand up, stretch, or look away from your screen.

- **Limit Social Media Intake**

  Aim for a maximum of 1-2 hours per day. Use app timers to help manage this.

- **Practice Eye Care**

  Follow the 20-20-20 rule: every 20 minutes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds.

- **Adopt the Pomodoro Technique**

  Work for 25 minutes, then take a 5-minute break. This structured approach boosts focus and prevents burnout.

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# Build an Identity Beyond Tech

Remember, you are more than your code, your GitHub profile, or your grades. Cultivate a well-rounded identity.







Hobbies off-screen help recharge your creativity and provide essential mental breaks. Engage in activities that bring you joy, away from the digital world.

Cultivate genuine social connections in person. Real-world relationships offer authentic support and validation, far beyond what online interactions can provide.

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